

LEVEL 1 • TERM 1 • LESSON 7 • FOR PARENTS

7 Take Away, Count Up

WHAT WE DID

We learned two ways to find the answer to a subtraction. To find how many are left, we take away the tens, then the ones. To find how far apart two numbers are (the difference), we count up the gap. This term goes beyond the school Primary 1 syllabus on purpose, with bars and squares to help.

> **The difference is a gap. Take away to see what is left. Count up to see the gap.**

TRY AT HOME (5 MINUTES)

1. Two piles: make two piles of small things, such as 38 and 62 coins or buttons. Ask: how many more in the big pile? Count up the gap together: hop to the next ten, jump by tens, hop to the number.
2. Take it away: say a number up to 80 and a number of tens and ones to take away, such as 68 take away 25. Take the tens first, then the ones. Then check by adding the answer back.
3. Spot it: look at two page numbers, two house numbers or two ages. Ask: how far from one to the other? Which way is quicker, taking away or counting up?

When your child is stuck

Please let your child use real things or draw bars and squares, and wait 10 seconds before helping. Asking 'What is the next ten?' works better than giving the answer.

Words we used

- take away: find what is left (57 - 24 = 33)
- count up: find the gap from the smaller number to the greater number
- difference: the gap between two numbers
- check: add the answer back to the number taken away

Good questions

- How do you know?
- Which is quicker here, taking away or counting up? Why?
- How can you check your answer?

Things to have ready

- The printed workbook (pages 1 to 5) and the kit page (tens bars and ones squares), already cut out by a grown-up
- A pencil, a rubber and spare paper
- A pencil of a different colour for checking your own work

Next lesson

Lesson 8: Balance and Swap. Your child needs a pencil and paper only. Missed a lesson? Every lesson is recorded; your tutor will share a private link with enrolled families.